PADHAKU
First Flight · Class 10 English

CHAPTER 5

Glimpses of India

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.
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⭐ Glimpses of India · Before You Read

1 **What images — of people and of places — come to your mind, when you think of our country?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Snow-capped Himalayas, the Taj Mahal, the beaches of Goa and Kerala, tea gardens of Assam, deserts of Rajasthan.

People of many religions, languages and dresses living together; colourful festivals like Diwali, Eid, Christmas and Pongal.

2 **What parts of India have you lived in, or visited? Can you name some popular tourist destinations?**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

(Personal answer) e.g. I live in Delhi and have visited Jaipur and Shimla.

Popular destinations: Agra (Taj Mahal), Goa, Jaipur, Shimla, Manali, Kerala backwaters, Darjeeling, Varanasi, Andaman Islands.

3 **Apart from the British, the Dutch and the French, the Portuguese have also played a part in the history of our country. Can you say which parts of India show French and Portuguese influences?**

✔ ANSWER

French influence: Puducherry (Pondicherry), Karaikal, Mahe, Yanam, Chandernagore.

Portuguese influence: Goa, Daman and Diu, and parts of Mumbai (Bassein/Vasai).

4 **Can you say which parts of India grow (i) tea, (ii) coffee?**

✔ ANSWER

(i) **Tea:** Assam, West Bengal (Darjeeling), Kerala, Tamil Nadu (Nilgiris), Himachal Pradesh.

(ii) **Coffee:** Karnataka (Coorg/Kodagu, Chikmagalur), Kerala, Tamil Nadu.

⭐ A Baker from Goa · Oral Comprehension Check (1)

1 **What are the elders in Goa nostalgic about?**

✔ ANSWER

The elders in Goa think fondly of the good old Portuguese days, the Portuguese people and their famous loaves of bread.

2 **Is bread-making still popular in Goa? How do you know?**

✔ ANSWER

Yes. The mixers, moulders and bakers are still there, the age-old furnaces still burn, and the thud and jingle of the baker's bamboo can still be heard in some places. Sons carry on the family profession.

3 **What is the baker called?**

✔ ANSWER

In Goa the baker is called a **pader**.

4 **When would the baker come everyday? Why did the children run to meet him?**

✔ ANSWER

The baker came twice a day: once in the morning on his selling round and again when he returned after emptying his basket.

The children ran to meet him not for the loaves but for the bread-bangles (and sometimes special sweet bread) they chose carefully.

⭐ A Baker from Goa · Oral Comprehension Check (2)

1 **Match the following. What is a must**

(i) as marriage gifts? – cakes and bolinhas

(ii) for a party or a feast? – sweet bread called bol

(iii) for a daughter's engagement? – bread

(iv) for Christmas? – sandwiches

✔ ANSWER

(i) as marriage gifts – **sweet bread called bol**

(ii) for a party or a feast – **bread**

(iii) for a daughter's engagement – **sandwiches**

(iv) for Christmas – **cakes and bolinhas**

2 **What did the bakers wear: (i) in the Portuguese days? (ii) when the author was young?**

✔ ANSWER

(i) In the Portuguese days they wore a **kabai**, a single-piece long frock reaching down to the knees.

(ii) When the author was young they wore a shirt and trousers shorter than full-length ones and longer than half pants.

3 **Who invites the comment — "he is dressed like a pader"? Why?**

✔ ANSWER

Anyone who wears a half pant that reaches just below the knees invites this comment, because bakers (paders) used to wear such knee-length trousers.

4 **Where were the monthly accounts of the baker recorded?**

✔ ANSWER

The monthly accounts were recorded in pencil on some wall of the house.

5 **What does a 'jackfruit-like appearance' mean?**

✔ ANSWER

It means a plump, round, pleasantly fat body, like a jackfruit. Bakers looked like this because baking was profitable and they never starved.

🤔 A Baker from Goa · Thinking about the Text

1 **Which of these statements are correct?**

(i) The pader was an important person in the village in old times.

(ii) Paders still exist in Goan villages.

(iii) The paders went away with the Portuguese.

(iv) The paders continue to wear a single-piece long frock.

(v) Bread and cakes were an integral part of Goan life in the old days.

(vi) Traditional bread-baking is still a very profitable business.

(vii) Paders and their families starve in the present times.

✔ ANSWER

Correct: (i), (ii), (v).

Not correct: (iii) – the makers are still there; (iv) – the kabai was worn in the old days; (vi) – the text says baking *was* profitable 'in the old days'; (vii) – the text says the baker and his family never starved.

2 **Is bread an important part of Goan life? How do you know this?**

✔ ANSWER

Yes, bread is very important in Goan life.

- Marriage gifts are meaningless without the sweet bread called **bol**.
- A party or feast loses its charm without bread.
- Sandwiches must be prepared for a daughter's engagement.
- Cakes and **bolinhas** are a must for Christmas and other festivals.

So the baker's furnace is "absolutely essential" in a village.

3 Tick the right answer. What is the tone of the author when he says the following?

(i) The thud and the jingle of the traditional baker's bamboo can still be heard in some places. (nostalgic, hopeful, sad)

(ii) Maybe the father is not alive but the son still carries on the family profession. (nostalgic, hopeful, sad)

(iii) I still recall the typical fragrance of those loaves. (nostalgic, hopeful, naughty)

(iv) The tiger never brushed his teeth. Hot tea could wash and clean up everything so nicely, after all. (naughty, angry, funny)

(v) Cakes and bolinhas are a must for Christmas as well as other festivals. (sad, hopeful, matter-of-fact)

(vi) The baker and his family never starved. They always looked happy and prosperous. (matter-of-fact, hopeful, sad)

✔ ANSWER

(i) **hopeful**

(ii) **hopeful**

(iii) **nostalgic**

(iv) **funny**

(v) **matter-of-fact**

(vi) **matter-of-fact**

I **In this extract, the author talks about traditional bread-baking during his childhood days. Complete the following table with the help of the clues on the left. Then write a paragraph about the author's childhood days.**

Clues: the way bread was baked; the way the pader sold bread; what the pader wore; when the pader was paid; how the pader looked

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Clues	Author's childhood days
the way bread was baked	in age-old, time-tested furnaces
the way the pader sold bread	door to door, carrying the basket on his head and announcing his arrival with the 'jhang, jhang' of his bamboo staff, twice a day
what the pader wore	a shirt and trousers shorter than full-length and longer than half pants (earlier, a long frock called kabai)
when the pader was paid	at the end of the month; accounts were written in pencil on a wall
how the pader looked	plump, happy and prosperous, with a 'jackfruit-like' physique

Paragraph: In the author's childhood, the Goan baker, or pader, baked bread in old, time-tested furnaces. He came twice a day, carrying a huge basket on his head and banging his bamboo staff with a 'jhang, jhang' sound. The children ran to him for bread-bangles and sweet bread, while the maid bought the loaves. He wore knee-length trousers and a shirt. He collected his bills at the end of the month, and the accounts were written in pencil on a wall. Baking was profitable, so the baker and his family always looked plump, happy and prosperous.

II.1 **Compare the piece from the text (on the left) with the other piece on Goan bakers (on the right, adapted from Nandakumar Kamat's 'The Unsung Lives of Goan Paders'). What makes the two texts so different? Are the facts the same? Do both writers give you a picture of the baker?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Facts:** Mostly the same – people remember the Portuguese bread nostalgically, and the paders still survive, with the profession passed down in families.

- **Difference:** The text (Lucio Rodrigues) is personal and nostalgic, full of sounds and memories ('thud and jingle', 'fire in the furnaces'). Kamat's piece is impersonal and factual; it gives reasons (door-to-door delivery, family tradition) and the fact that leavened bread is a Portuguese gift.
- **Picture of the baker:** Only the first text gives a lively picture of the baker; the second gives information, not a picture.

II.2 **Now find a travel brochure about a place you have visited. Look at the description in the brochure. Then write your own account, adding details from your own experience, to give the reader a picture of the place, rather than an impersonal, factual description.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

My Visit to Shimla

The brochure called Shimla "the Queen of Hills, at 2,200 metres, with colonial buildings and pleasant weather". For me, Shimla was much more. When our bus climbed the winding road, the air suddenly turned cool and smelt of pine. In the evening we walked on the crowded Mall Road, where the lights of the hillside houses twinkled like stars. We ate hot momos and sipped tea while monkeys watched us from the railings of Christ Church. Next morning, a toy train ride through 100 tunnels made my little brother scream with joy. Standing at the Ridge, I saw snow-covered peaks glowing pink at sunrise. I still remember that chill on my cheeks and long to go back.

💬 A Baker from Goa · Group Discussion

1 **In groups, collect information on how bakeries bake bread now and how the process has changed over time.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Earlier:** dough mixed and moulded by hand; baked in wood-fired clay or brick furnaces; fresh bread sold door to door by the baker.
- **Now:** electric mixers, moulding machines and electric/gas ovens; large factories produce sliced, packed bread with preservatives; sold in shops and online.

- Process is faster, cleaner and uniform, but the personal touch and the special taste/fragrance of traditional bread are less.

2 **There are a number of craft-based professions which are dying out. Pick one of the crafts below. Make a group presentation to the class about the skills required, and the possible reasons for the decline of the craft. Can you think of ways to revive these crafts?**
(i) Pottery (ii) Batik work (iii) Dhurri (rug) weaving (iv) Embroidery (v) Carpentry (vi) Bamboo weaving (vii) Making jute products (viii) Handloom

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Craft chosen: Pottery

- **Skills:** preparing clay, shaping it on the potter's wheel, drying, firing in a kiln, painting and glazing; patience and a steady hand.
- **Reasons for decline:** cheap plastic, steel and machine-made goods; low income; young people leaving for other jobs; lack of good clay and markets.
- **Ways to revive:** government help and loans, craft fairs and online selling, training young people, using clay pots as eco-friendly alternatives to plastic, linking with tourism and designer products.

🤔 Coorg · Thinking about the Text

1 **Where is Coorg?**

✔ ANSWER

Coorg (Kodagu), the smallest district of Karnataka, lies midway between Mysore and the coastal town of Mangalore.

2 **What is the story about the Kodavu people's descent?**

✔ ANSWER

The Kodavus are possibly of Greek or Arabic descent. One story says a part of Alexander's army moved south along the coast and settled here when return became impractical; they married locals. The other theory of Arab origin is supported by their long black coat with an embroidered waist-belt, the **kuppia**, which resembles the Arab **kuffia**.

3 **What are some of the things you now know about**

(i) the people of Coorg?

(ii) the main crop of Coorg?

(iii) the sports it offers to tourists?

(iv) the animals you are likely to see in Coorg?

(v) its distance from Bangalore, and how to get there?

✔ ANSWER

(i) They are a proud, fiercely independent, martial race; very hospitable; love telling tales of valour. The Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated; General Cariappa was a Coorgi; Kodavus may carry firearms without a licence.

(ii) **Coffee** (it is 'coffee country'); spices are also grown.

(iii) River rafting, canoeing, rappelling, rock climbing, mountain biking and trekking on walking trails.

(iv) Mahaseer fish, kingfishers, squirrels, langurs, elephants, macaques, Malabar squirrels, slender loris, birds, bees and butterflies.

(v) About 250–260 km from Bangalore by road, via Mysore (most used) or via Neelamangal, Kunigal and Chanrayanapatna. One can also fly to Bangalore or Mangalore, or take a train to Mysore, Mangalore or Hassan.

4 **Here are six sentences with some words in italics. Find phrases from the text that have the same meaning. (Look in the paragraphs indicated)**

(i) During monsoons it rains so heavily that *tourists do not visit Coorg*. (para 2)

(ii) *Some people say that* Alexander's army moved south along the coast and settled there. (para 3)

(iii) The Coorg people are *always ready to tell* stories of their sons' and fathers' valour. (para 4)

(iv) *Even people who normally lead an easy and slow life get smitten by* the high-energy adventure sports of Coorg. (para 6)

(v) The theory of the Arab origin *is supported by* the long coat with embroidered waist-belt they wear. (para 3)

(vi) Macaques, Malabar squirrels *observe you carefully* from the tree canopy. (para 7)

✔ ANSWER

(i) it pours enough to **keep many visitors away**

(ii) **As one story goes**

(iii) **more than willing to recount**

(iv) **The most laidback individuals become converts to**

(v) **draws support from**

(vi) **keep a watchful eye**

🤔 Coorg · Thinking about Language

Collocations

Look at the paired sentences and phrases below. Which is a common collocation, and which one is odd? Strike out the odd sentence or phrase.

(a) 'How old are you?' / 'How young are you?'

(b) a pleasant person / a pleasant pillow

✔ ANSWER

(a) Common: 'How old are you?' — odd (strike out): **'How young are you?'**

(b) Common: 'a pleasant person' — odd (strike out): **'a pleasant pillow'**

1 **Here are some nouns from the text: culture, monks, surprise, experience, weather, tradition. Discuss which of the nouns can collocate with which of the adjectives given below. The first one has been done for you.**

Adjectives: unique, terrible, unforgettable, serious, ancient, wide, sudden

(i) culture: unique culture, ancient culture

(ii) monks: (iii) surprise: (iv) experience: (v) weather: (vi) tradition:

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

(i) culture: unique culture, ancient culture

(ii) monks: serious monks, ancient monks

(iii) surprise: sudden surprise, unforgettable surprise, terrible surprise

(iv) experience: unique experience, unforgettable experience, terrible experience, wide experience

(v) weather: terrible weather, sudden (change in) weather

(vi) tradition: unique tradition, ancient tradition

2 **Complete the following phrases from the text. For each phrase, can you find at least one other word that would fit into the blank?**
(i) tales of ___ (ii) coastal ___ (iii) a piece of ___ (iv) evergreen ___ (v) ___ plantations (vi) ___ bridge (vii) wild ___

✔ ANSWER

Phrase from the text	Other words that fit
(i) tales of **valour**	bravery, courage, adventure
(ii) coastal **town**	area, city, region
(iii) a piece of **heaven**	cake, land, paper
(iv) evergreen **rainforests**	trees, forests
(v) **coffee** plantations	tea, rubber, sugarcane

(vi) **rope** bridge	wooden, railway, iron
(vii) wild **creatures** / **elephants**	animals, flowers, life

🤔 Tea from Assam · Thinking about Language

I.1 Look at these words: upkeep, downpour, undergo, dropout, walk-in. Use these words appropriately in the sentences below.

(i) A heavy ___ has been forecast due to low pressure in the Bay of Bengal.

(ii) Rakesh will ___ major surgery tomorrow morning.

(iii) My brother is responsible for the ___ of our family property.

(iv) The ___ rate for this accountancy course is very high.

(v) She went to the Enterprise Company to attend a ___ interview.

✔ ANSWER

(i) **downpour**

(ii) **undergo**

(iii) **upkeep**

(iv) **dropout**

(v) **walk-in**

I.2 Fill in the blanks by combining the verb given in brackets with one of the words from the box: over, by, through, out, up, down

(i) The Army attempted unsuccessfully to ___ the Government. (throw)

(ii) Scientists are on the brink of a major ___ in cancer research. (break)

(iii) The State Government plans to build a ___ for Bhubaneswar to speed up traffic on the main highway. (pass)

(iv) Gautama's ___ on life changed when he realised that the world is full of sorrow. (look)

(v) Rakesh seemed unusually ___ after the game. (cast)

✔ ANSWER

(i) **overthrow**

(ii) **breakthrough**

(iii) **bypass**

(iv) **outlook**

(v) **downcast**

II.1 Think of suitable -ing or -ed adjectives to answer the following questions. How would you describe

(i) a good detective serial on television?

(ii) a debate on your favourite topic 'Homework Should Be Banned'?

(iii) how you feel when you stay indoors due to incessant rain?

(iv) how you feel when you open a present?

(v) how you feel when you watch your favourite programme on television?

(vi) the look on your mother's face as you waited in a queue?

(vii) how you feel when tracking a tiger in a tiger reserve forest?

(viii) the story you have recently read, or a film you have seen?

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

(i) thrilling / exciting / interesting

(ii) interesting / exciting

(iii) bored / frustrated

(iv) excited / surprised / delighted

(v) relaxed / entertained / thrilled

(vi) bored / tired / irritated

(vii) thrilled / excited / frightened

(viii) interesting / amazing / touching

II.2 **Now use the adjectives in the exercise above, as appropriate, to write a paragraph about Coorg.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Coorg is an **amazing** place for anyone who is **bored** with city life. Its misty hills and coffee estates are truly **charming**, and the weather from September to March is **refreshing**. I was **thrilled** by the **exciting** adventure sports – river rafting, rock climbing and rappelling. Trekking through the forest, I felt **excited** and a little **frightened** when we saw wild elephants. The Kodavus' tales of valour were **interesting**, and meeting the Buddhist monks at Bylakuppe was a **surprising** bonus. I came back **relaxed** and **delighted**.

⭐ Tea from Assam · Speaking and Writing

1 **Read the following passage about tea. (India and tea are so intertwined ... attributing to it numerous medicinal properties. – Ranjit Biswas, The Hindu)**

Collect information about tea. Then form groups of five and play the following roles: a tea planter, a sales agent, a tea lover (consumer), a physician and a tea-shop owner. Each person has to put forward his/her views about tea, using phrases such as 'I feel...', 'I disagree with you...', 'I suggest...'.

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Tea planter: I would like you to know that Assam has the largest concentration of tea plantations in the world. The second flush, from May to July, gives the best tea.

Sales agent: I feel Indian tea has a great market both at home and abroad. It is important to know that people want new flavours like green tea and masala tea.

Tea lover: I think that tea is the best start to the day. A hot cup refreshes me and banishes sleep.

Physician: I agree with you, but I am afraid too much tea with sugar is harmful. Two or three cups a day are fine. Green tea has antioxidants that are good for the heart.

Tea-shop owner: May I know why you worry so much? It is my feeling that tea brings people together. I suggest we serve it fresh and less sweet.

2 **You are the sales executive of a famous tea company and you have been asked to draft an advertisement for the product. Draft the advertisement using the information you collected for the role play.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

ASSAM GOLD TEA

Wake up to the freshness of Assam!

- Hand-picked second-flush leaves from the finest gardens of Upper Assam

- Rich colour, strong taste, refreshing aroma
- Full of natural antioxidants – good for health
- Hygienically packed to keep the flavour fresh

Available in 250 g, 500 g and 1 kg packs

Special offer: a free mug with every 1 kg pack!

Available at all leading stores and online

Assam Gold – One sip, and the day is bright!

🤔 The Trees · Thinking about the Poem

1 **(i) Find, in the first stanza, three things that cannot happen in a treeless forest.**

(ii) What picture do these words create in your mind: "... sun bury its feet in shadow..."? What could the poet mean by the sun's 'feet'?

✔ ANSWER

(i) In a treeless forest, no bird could sit, no insect could hide, and the sun could not bury its feet in shadow.

(ii) It creates a picture of sunlight falling on the forest floor and getting lost in the shade of trees. The sun's 'feet' are its rays that reach the ground; in a treeless forest there is no shadow for them to 'hide' in.

2 **(i) Where are the trees in the poem? What do their roots, their leaves, and their twigs do?**

(ii) What does the poet compare their branches to?

✔ ANSWER

(i) The trees are inside the poet's house (on the veranda). All night the roots work to free themselves from the cracks in the veranda floor; the leaves strain towards the glass; the small twigs become stiff with effort.

(ii) She compares the long-cramped branches (boughs) to newly discharged patients, half-dazed, shuffling towards the clinic doors.

3 **(i) How does the poet describe the moon: (a) at the beginning of the third stanza, and (b) at its end? What causes this change?**

(ii) What happens to the house when the trees move out of it?

(iii) Why do you think the poet does not mention "the departure of the forest from the house" in her letters?

✔ ANSWER

(i) (a) At the beginning, the whole moon shines in a sky still open. (b) At the end, the moon is broken like a mirror and its pieces flash in the crown of the tallest oak. The change is caused by the trees moving out: their branches and leaves now cover the moon, so it is seen only in pieces through them.

(ii) The house becomes empty and silent: the glass breaks as the trees stumble out, and the whispers of the leaves will be silent tomorrow.

(iii) The departure is so strange and unexpected that people may not believe it, or she may feel embarrassed to talk about it. Often we are silent about important happenings that we cannot explain. Perhaps she also feels it is natural and needs no mention.

4 **Now that you have read the poem in detail, we can begin to ask what the poem might mean. Here are two suggestions. Can you think of others?**

(i) Does the poem present a conflict between man and nature? Compare it with A Tiger in the Zoo. Is the poet suggesting that plants and trees, used for 'interior decoration' in cities while forests are cut down, are 'imprisoned', and need to 'break out'?

(ii) On the other hand, Adrienne Rich has been known to use trees as a metaphor for human beings; this is a recurrent image in her poetry. What new meanings emerge from the poem if you take its trees to be symbolic of this particular meaning?

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

(i) Yes. Like the tiger locked in a concrete cell in 'A Tiger in the Zoo', the trees are imprisoned in a house as decoration while real forests are cut down. Both long to return to their natural home. The poet suggests that nature cannot be held captive for long; it will break free and reclaim the empty forest.

(ii) If trees stand for human beings, especially women, the house stands for the limits set by society and family. The trees' struggle to break out shows people's struggle for freedom and identity. Like 'newly discharged patients', they are half-dazed but determined to move into the open world.

Other meanings: the poem may show how humans ignore nature's suffering; or that every living being wants freedom.

5 **You may read the poem 'On Killing a Tree' by Gieve Patel (Beehive – Textbook in English for Class IX, NCERT). Compare and contrast it with the poem you have just read.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- **Similarity:** Both poems show trees as living beings with strength and feelings, and both point to man's cruelty to nature.
- **'On Killing a Tree':** shows how hard it is to kill a tree – only uprooting it, exposing its roots to sun and air, kills it. It is about destruction by man.

- **'The Trees':** shows trees escaping from a house where man has confined them. It is about nature's struggle for freedom and its return to the forest.
- **Tone:** Patel's is ironic and grim; Rich's is calm, mysterious and hopeful.

Homophones

Can you find the words below that are spelt similarly, and sometimes even pronounced similarly, but have very different meanings? Check their pronunciation and meaning in a dictionary.

• The dump was so full that it had to refuse more refuse.

• When shot at, the dove dove into the bushes.

• The insurance was invalid for the invalid.

✔ ANSWER

- **refuse** (verb, re-FUSE) = to say no; **refuse** (noun, REF-use) = waste, garbage.
- **dove** (noun, rhymes with 'love') = a bird like a pigeon; **dove** (verb, rhymes with 'stove') = past tense of 'dive'.
- **invalid** (adjective, in-VAL-id) = not valid, not legally acceptable; **invalid** (noun, IN-va-lid) = a person made weak by illness or injury.

(Strictly, these are **homographs**: same spelling, different meaning and pronunciation.)

🎉 **Chapter 5 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**